

sibhon

The fourth town of Nardan, just outside of Amsterdam, is a must-see if you are coming to the Netherlands. I caught up with one of the locals, professional singer Siobhan, and her superstar daughter, Chersha. Travel Radio Australia.

And this month we're travelling around the Netherlands and we're in a lovely town, which is about, I suppose, 15 minutes on the train from central Amsterdam. It's called Nardan. And in Nardan, how can I describe it? It's a very old-fashioned Spanish fort, absolutely beautiful.

If you look it up on the web and you can see the overhead views, you get a great idea. I'm sitting here with one of the residents in this beautiful Dutch house, Siobhan. And we're here with her family here.

And Siobhan, welcome to the program. Thank you very much, Jeff. Hi.

And you're here with a very special guest as well. Well, yeah, she's here actually every day. Maybe she'd like to introduce herself.

Hi, I'm Siobhan. I'm from the Netherlands. And I'm 10.

Great. And it's your daughter. And it's a lovely, lovely place here.

And I know it's a lovely place because I was actually the magician at your daughter's birthday party a couple of years ago. And we're in the forest here. Siobhan, can you tell us a little about Nardan itself? You've been living here for quite a while.

Yeah, well, not very long, about four years before that we were living in Amsterdam. So whenever we came here, we're like, oh, this is so nice and it's so cozy. And we felt like we were like in an old painting because it's a fort, an old fort in the shape of a star.

If you fly over it, you'll see a star shaped fort. And it has so much history and so much ambience. And still, it's very nice and cozy.

We have a little theater called The Mess. We have a bakery. You can have a lovely dinner at A Fusion, which is sushi.

And Saoirse loves that, don't you? Yeah, I love sushi. It's my favorite food. And an Italian place and also like you can have drinks at the Demers.

So it's really nice. You have like everything. And still, it's like you were saying, only 20 minutes away from Amsterdam.

So nature, oxygen and still near everything. So yeah, we love it here. Now, in the summertime, especially here, and it's beautiful all year round because you have the snow in the winter and the

beautiful summer time.

And in the summertime, there's festivals and events. Can you tell us about those? Yeah, lots of things going on, theater festivals. Actually, only yesterday with our street, we were sitting outside and having a lovely lunch and dinner.

And everybody brings some food and I was singing some songs and we all come together. So the community is really nice to have those kinds of things. And Saoirse was actually at the music festival this year.

Yeah, that was very lovely and it was very cool. What kind of music? Yeah. Was it Dutch music or a bit of everything? Yeah, Dutch music.

And you sing yourself as well? Yeah. And your mother is a very top professional singer in the Netherlands. I mean, your mother worked at Past Air Buster in Amsterdam as one of the featured artists there for many, many years.

And could you tell me, Siobhan, a bit about that? Because you were very high up in the Amsterdam entertainment scene and you're a bit retired now from that. And you're a full-time mom and that was great as well. Yeah, definitely.

Well, the good thing is I'm combining the best of both worlds because I still have my own company. It's called Acting Beauty. So I still go around and sing and act and think of all these different kinds of things to do on parties and events.

But I also have the quietness and the stillness. And I loved working at Past Air Buster, I did that for 18 years. And well, you know how it goes when you start entertaining as a magician yourself, you just can't stop.

You have to continue doing that. So that's what I still do nowadays. And yeah, like I'm saying, the best of both worlds.

And the history of Nardan itself and how you spell it is N-A-A-R-D-E-N, Nardan. Does it have any meaning or anything like that? But I know the Spanish were here first when they built it. No, no, they didn't.

They invaded us. So it was a really cruel masquerade. Actually, the biggest bloodbath Holland has known in history.

It was in 1572 and they came in and I think like 800 Dutch people were murdered. And yeah, that's something that's still, you know, you can go to the Fasting Museum right here and you'll see the whole history about that. But it's something that's still going around and that really has left a mark on Nardefesting.

Yes. And like I said, if people look at it from the air online, it's so beautiful. The lines are incredible.

You have like an enchanted forest on the island here because it is an island, isn't it? It's a star-shaped island, basically. Yes, it is. But it has three bridges, actually.

So it's not really. But yeah, we have the fortress ramparts and along the fortress ramparts there's the water. Now, I believe there was a bit of an incident five years ago which made huge news in Nardau, yes? Yeah, well, it's just so funny because it was a burglar, a thief, who stole the jewelry from here, from the jewelry shop.

And then what they did is they just lifted the three bridges. So yes, the fortress became an island and he couldn't leave the island. So, of course, they caught a thief, they got back the jewelry and then they put back the bridges down.

That was so funny, yes. So it is an island in a certain way. So we'd have to swim to get off the island.

And it was built as a defensive island in the Netherlands, wasn't it? Yeah. And it's so beautiful from the air. I really encourage people to do that, to have a look and all that kind of thing.

And what are the best times for people to come? I mean, it's winter and summer here, whatever. It's always beautiful. Yes, it is.

Yeah, it's very diverse. Of course, the most beautiful time in the year is spring when everything starts to bloom. And the whole fortress is covered within flowers and it's so nice.

It really is, yes. But also in winter, you know, in winter we take our sledge and we go sledging down the hills. And in summer we swim in the water and in autumn it's beautiful because of all the leaves.

Well, you know, all the seasons they'll have their own magic. And what's your favorite thing to do here at Northern? I think play on the streets because in Amsterdam there are cars and people and everything. And here is it.

There are no cars. There's no one. So you can play outside.

Now, I've been here with your family when you've all been in the winter. I know that's a very special time for you because you guys go to school on sleds, don't you? Yeah, we can. So in Australia, I think, they're not... You can't do that in Australia, only in our ski mountains, but not in the normal town like you can do here.

Yeah, but here we can go, I think, on grass or on some other things, places. We were even ice skating in the winter, weren't we, underwater? Yeah, that was very, very nice. I like it.

Yeah, it's such a lovely place for children here. And I suppose all the children on the fort here know each other because it's a very... There's only, what, one or two schools here, right? Yeah, there's only one school. It's a tiny school.

It's right opposite here. Actually, I believe it was in the quote in the top three of best places to raise children was Narda Festing. So it's very safe and it's a very nice place.

And Festing means fort, right? Yes, Festing means fort. Narda Festing, that's great. Well, thank you so much for being with us on the program.

Now it's Siobhan, and how do we say your name again? Saoirse. Saoirse, a very Irish name. That's great.

But you're Netherlands. You were born here. Yeah, I'm born here, but my grandpa is Irish, but I don't know where he is now.

We don't know. Oh, Irish people are like that. They're always traveling.

They're always disappearing somewhere. Yeah, yeah. Like myself.

We're always traveling in some kind of place. The Irish travelers, that's us. Yes, that's right.

Yeah, yeah. So, Siobhan, thank you very much for being with us on the program. Can you say hello to everyone in Australia in Dutch for us? Can you do that? Hello.

Hello, everyone. I'm here with you today. I'm from Australia.

And I'm very happy to be here with you today. And I brought a beautiful koala bear back from Australia for you. What do you think? I love it.

It's so cute. I like it. Yeah, I really like it.

Thanks for being with us on the program this month. Travel Radio Australia. You're welcome.